

Which carrier should place our patient calls into Bangladesh?

PREPARED FOR MENTOR REVIEW

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DECISION OWNER: CLARUS TEAM

WHERE WE ARE

Clarus places outbound AI voice calls to patients in Bangladesh — appointment reminders and lab follow-up, in Bangla, through an ElevenLabs conversational agent.

The agent works. The workflow engine parks at a call node and resumes from the post-call webhook. What is missing is the phone leg: every number we dial is **+880**, and we do not yet have a carrier that can legally and reliably terminate those calls. Today we prove the path over WebRTC in the browser, with no carrier in the loop.

Three routes are open to us, and they are not variations on the same thing — they differ in cost by an order of magnitude, in setup time by months, and in legal exposure by a great deal. We would like guidance on which one to commit to.

COST OF A THREE-MINUTE PATIENT CALL

TWILIO

\$0.060 /min

Published rate to Bangladesh landline and mobile. Inbound \$0.004/min.

3-min call ≈ \$0.18 · no +880 caller ID

TELNYX

\$0.002 /min + term.

Call-control fee is published; the Bangladesh termination rate sits behind their SIP price sheet and we have not been quoted it.

3-min call ≈ unknown · +880 number from \$1/mo

LOCAL IPTSP TRUNK

৳0.40–2.00 /min

BTRC-regulated off-net tariff band. Roughly \$0.003–\$0.016/min at ৳122 to the dollar.

3-min call ≈ \$0.01–0.05 · native +880 caller ID

SIDE BY SIDE

	TWILIO	TELNYX	LICENSED BD IPTSP
+880 CALLER ID	NO Twilio publishes Bangladesh regulatory guidelines, but we have not been able to buy BD inventory. Patients would see a foreign number.	YES National and mobile BD numbers listed, from \$1/mo.	YES Native local numbering is the whole point of the licence.
VOICE RATE	\$0.060/min out, \$0.004/min in	\$0.002/min platform + BD termination (unquoted)	₹0.40-2.00/min off-net; on-net ₹0-0.20
FIXED COST	None beyond usage	~\$1/mo per number	Monthly line rent up to ₹150 + signup up to ₹300, per BTRC tariff; commercial trunk terms vary by provider
ONBOARDING	Self-serve, same day	Business registration certificate, rep ID, signed LOI, proof of address; ~72h validation. Business use only	Commercial negotiation with a licensed operator — weeks to months, and it has already proven slow for us
REGULATORY STANDING	WEAK International VoIP termination into BD that bypasses a licensed IGW/ICX is an offence under the Telecom Act 2001. BTRC actively fines and seizes	UNCLEAR Numbers are sold, but the underlying termination arrangement is not visible to us	CLEAN Traffic rides a licensed operator's interconnect. This is the sanctioned path
ELEVENLABS FIT	Native integration — one endpoint, automatic webhook setup	Documented SIP-trunk integration	Generic SIP trunk into the same ElevenLabs SIP endpoint
COST TO SWITCH LATER	Low for all three. Our ElevenLabs client changes one constant — <code>/v1/convai/twilio/outbound-call</code> becomes <code>/v1/convai/sip-trunk/outbound-call</code> . Nothing else in the call path moves.		

Twilio

The fastest thing to stand up, and the one we are least sure we are allowed to run.

FOR

- Native ElevenLabs integration; the outbound call path already assumes it
- No contracts, no documents, no waiting — we could dial today
- Mature tooling: recording, transcription, logs, sandbox
- Best option if we later expand outside Bangladesh

AGAINST

- No +880 caller ID we can obtain — patients see an unknown foreign number, which is fatal for answer rates on a health call
- Ten to twenty times the per-minute cost of a local trunk
- Terminating foreign VoIP into BD outside a licensed gateway is exactly what BTRC prosecutes
- Least defensible position if a clinic's compliance officer asks how the calls are carried

Telnyx

The middle path: a real +880 number without a licence of our own — if the termination story holds up.

FOR

- Bangladesh national and mobile numbers are actually offered, from \$1/mo
- Cheapest published platform fee of the three vendors
- Documented ElevenLabs SIP integration; no bespoke work
- ~72h onboarding — days, not months

AGAINST

- The Bangladesh termination rate is not public; we cannot finish the cost model without a quote
- KYC is real: business registration, representative ID, signed LOI, matching proof of address
- Whether their BD route is interconnect-legal for our traffic is not something we can verify from outside
- Business-use only — no fallback to a personal account while we are pre-incorporation

A licensed Bangladeshi IPTSP trunk

Buying capacity from an existing licence holder — not applying for our own. Worth separating those two, because our own licence is not realistic: nationwide acquisition runs ₳10 lakh with ₳5 lakh annually, a ₳10 lakh bank guarantee, 2% of gross revenue from year three, and applicants must already hold an ISP licence.

FOR

- An order of magnitude cheaper per minute than Twilio, at a BTRC-published tariff
- Native +880 caller ID — the single biggest lever on whether patients answer
- Unambiguously legal: traffic rides a licensed interconnect
- Local call quality and a local counterparty when something breaks

AGAINST

- Slow to arrange — we have been at it and do not have a trunk yet
- Commercial terms are negotiated, not listed; hard to budget before we sign
- Self-serve developer tooling is far weaker than either US vendor
- BTRC's 2025 licensing overhaul is collapsing licence categories, so we would be signing into a regime that is mid-change
- Ties us to one country's regulatory perimeter

WHAT WE COULD NOT SETTLE OURSELVES

PRICING	Telnyx's Bangladesh termination rate is behind a sales quote. Until we have it, the Telnyx column of our cost model is a blank.
LEGALITY	We can read that unlicensed international VoIP termination is prosecuted. We cannot tell where a foreign vendor selling BD numbers sits on that line.
ANSWER RATES	We assume a foreign caller ID badly hurts pickup on a health call from an unknown number. We have no Bangladesh data to size that.
REGIME CHANGE	The Telecommunications Network and Licensing Policy 2025 is reshaping IPTSP. Whether a trunk signed now survives that transition is beyond us.

WHAT WE'RE ASKING

For an AI voice product calling patients in Bangladesh, should we build the phone leg on Twilio, on Telnyx, or hold out for a SIP trunk from a licensed Bangladeshi IPTSP?

- 01

Is running outbound patient calls into Bangladesh over Twilio or Telnyx a real regulatory exposure for us under the Telecom Act, or is that risk carried entirely by the carrier?

This is the question that decides it. If the exposure is ours, cost stops mattering.
- 02

How much does a foreign caller ID actually cost us in answer rate for a clinical call in Bangladesh?

If it's marginal, Twilio buys us months. If it's severe, only a +880 trunk works and everything else is a detour.
- 03

Is Telnyx a genuine middle path — a compliant +880 presence without our own licence — or does it merely move the same problem behind a vendor?
- 04

Is it defensible to pilot on a US carrier with a small number of consenting patients while an IPTSP trunk is negotiated, or does even a pilot need the licensed route?

Switching costs us one constant in the ElevenLabs client, so a staged approach is cheap — if it's allowed.
- 05

Given the 2025 licensing reform, is now a bad moment to sign a multi-year IPTSP trunk agreement?
- 06

Do you know an IPTSP operator who already carries automated or call-centre voice traffic and would talk to an early-stage team?

Our blocker on this path has been access, not willingness.

SOURCES AND RATE ASSUMPTIONS

Twilio Bangladesh voice pricing — [twilio.com/en-us/voice/pricing/bd](https://www.twilio.com/en-us/voice/pricing/bd) — <https://www.twilio.com/en-us/voice/pricing/bd>

Twilio Bangladesh regulatory guidelines — [twilio.com/en-us/guidelines/bd/regulatory](https://www.twilio.com/en-us/guidelines/bd/regulatory) — <https://www.twilio.com/en-us/guidelines/bd/regulatory>

Telnyx voice API pricing — telnyx.com/pricing/call-control — <https://telnyx.com/pricing/call-control>

Telnyx Bangladesh DID requirements — support.telnyx.com/en/articles/12748292-bangladesh-did-requirements — <https://support.telnyx.com/en/articles/12748292-bangladesh-did-requirements>

BTRC IPTSP licensing guideline (fees, 15-year term, 2% AGR revenue share, ISP-licensee eligibility) — [lims.btrc.gov.bd/uploads/service_guideline/IPTSP Guideline.pdf](https://lims.btrc.gov.bd/uploads/service_guideline/IPTSP%20Guideline.pdf) — https://lims.btrc.gov.bd/uploads/service_guideline/IPTSP%20Guideline.pdf

IPTSP retail tariff band, ₳0.40–2.00/min off-net, ₳0–0.20/min on-net, +15% VAT — [bol-online.com/iptsp-tariff](https://www.bol-online.com/iptsp-tariff) — <https://www.bol-online.com/iptsp-tariff>

BTRC fines over illegal VoIP SIMs, Tk 8.68 crore across 8,682 SIMs — [thedailystar.net](https://www.thedailystar.net/business/news/btrc-fines-four-mobile-operators-tk-868cr-over-illegal-voip-sims-4232781) — <https://www.thedailystar.net/business/news/btrc-fines-four-mobile-operators-tk-868cr-over-illegal-voip-sims-4232781>

Telecommunications Network and Licensing Policy 2025 — [tbsnews.net](https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/telecom/btrc-outlines-telecom-licensing-regime-simplification-limits-licensing-layers-3) — <https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/telecom/btrc-outlines-telecom-licensing-regime-simplification-limits-licensing-layers-3>

ElevenLabs telephony integrations — elevenlabs.io/agents/integrations — <https://elevenlabs.io/agents/integrations>

Currency conversions use ₳122 ≈ \$1. All per-minute figures exclude ElevenLabs conversational-AI charges, which are the same whichever carrier we pick.